Consumption Expenditure

The consumption expenditure data was collected by (NSSO) through various rounds of Household Consumer Expenditure Surveys (HCES). It has been conducting these surveys based on large samples quinquennially from 1972–73. These surveys are the primary source of data on various indicators of living standards of different strata of the population at the national and state levels. They are used for planning, policy formulation, decision making and as inputs for further statistical exercises by various government organisations academicians, researchers and scholars.

Based on these surveys various reports are being published by NSSO. These reports are assigned with a particular serial no. For example one of the reports based on the 68th round is Level and Pattern of Consumer Expenditure 2011–12 (LAPOCE 2011–12). Its serial no is NSS Report N0.555 (68/1.0/1). In short Report No 555.

A detailed description of household consumer expenditure is given in the chapter Two of Report No 555. The initial paragraph of the same is reproduced below:

> *"2.1.2* **Household consumer expenditure:** *The expenditure incurred by a household on domestic consumption during the reference period is the household's consumer expenditure. Expenditure incurred towards productive enterprises of households is excluded from household consumer expenditure. Also excluded are expenditure on purchase and construction of residential land and building, interest payments, insurance premium payments, payments of fines and penalties, and expenditure on gambling including lottery tickets. Money given as remittance, charity, gift, etc. is not consumer expenditure. However, self-consumed produce of own farm or other household enterprise is valued and included in household consumer expenditure. So are goods and services received as payment in kind or free from employer, such as accommodation and medical care, and travelling allowance excluding allowance for business trips."*